

Kalina Kazmierczak

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EDUCATION

Virginia Tech

*Bachelor of Science in Computer Science; Human Computer Interaction Minor
Cum Laude*

Blacksburg, VA

August 2021 - May 2025

WORK EXPERIENCE

Full-Stack Software Engineer

CoStar Group

Arlington, VA

July 2025 – Present

- Design and implement RESTful APIs and data models for internal developer tools, balancing technical constraints with real user needs.
- Integrated S3-backed data sources with vector stores to support semantic retrieval over internal documentation and model metadata.
- Built an AI-powered developer knowledge layer over composable ETL data models, enabling semantic queries into model behavior, data lineage, and inter-model dependencies with sourced, documentation-backed answers.
- Build reusable React component systems that balance flexibility with consistency across teams and products.

Undergraduate Research Assistant

Virginia Tech

Blacksburg, VA

Jan 2023 – May 2025

- Reverse-engineered and restored a legacy kinetic sculpture system, migrating from a non-functional Mac Mini installation to Raspberry Pi hardware without documentation.
- Built interactive JavaScript visualizations and contributed to a Python backend to make complex technical achievements accessible to broader audiences.
- Selected as 1 of 5 students to present at the SC23 International Conference (13,000+ attendees), communicating technical work to highly diverse audiences.

Software Engineer Intern

CoStar Group

Richmond, VA

June 2024 – August 2024

- Designed and shipped a production dashboard for monitoring AWS CloudWatch SQS queues, used daily by multiple teams for operations and incident response.
- Led product development end-to-end, translating developer needs into fast, information-dense interfaces built with React and Highcharts.
- Implemented advanced filtering and customization for keyboard-first workflows, iterating quickly based on real developer feedback.

PROJECTS

Mabawa Scratch Coding Workshop | Nyamyumba, Rwanda

- Designed a programming curriculum for 3rd-grade students with no prior experience; recognized with the Emily Specchio Foundation Scholarship.

Bun Appétit (1st place VTURCS)

- Designed and built a gamified food journaling app exploring interaction patterns for AI-powered photo recognition.
- Created custom AI prompts and iterated on confidence-scoring mechanics to balance accuracy with engaging gameplay.

SKILLS

- **Design & Prototyping:** Figma, UI/UX design, interaction design, rapid prototyping
- **Development:** JavaScript, React, Python, C#, C, HTML/CSS, Git, Linux
- **Developer Platforms:** AWS (S3, CloudWatch), SQL, Vector Stores, Internal Developer Tools
- **AI Systems:** Semantic retrieval (RAG), prompt design for documentation-grounded LLM responses, hallucination mitigation